



[Weekly Market Commentary](#)

Dear clients,

Large cap crypto names have continued to trade sideways, continuing the trend that started when President Trump initiated tariffs on February 1. That is, markets have traded in a fairly orderly way, in our view, despite Trump reinstating tariffs on steel and aluminum imports (to begin March 12) and announcing reciprocal tariffs on other products for multiple trading partners (to begin April 1). Meanwhile, investors mostly dismissed initial concerns over inflation after CPI data for January came in above expectations.

Elsewhere, Solana's validators recently activated SIMD-96, which changes how priority fee payments are handled. Previously, 50% of those fees were burned, but now they will go directly to validators, which is a significant shift in SOL's tokenomics since most of the network's transaction fees are priority fees. That said, while this could increase SOL's token supply in the short-term, we think other possible upcoming changes like SIMD-228 could be more meaningful in the long run.

Finally, we just published our [Monthly Outlook: Standards and Exceptions](#) (February 12), where despite recent crypto market fluctuations, we believe positive regulatory developments and favorable macro trends affirm our constructive 1Q25 market view. However, we think the divergence in institutional vs retail sentiment may anchor that outlook more on bitcoin than altcoins.

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Best,
The Coinbase Institutional Team

Weekly Market Call

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